

ABES INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

**CODE OF CONDUCT
AND
POLICY MANUAL**

Institutional Code of Conduct and Policy Manual

Preamble

This document outlines the Code of Conduct and Institutional Policy Guidelines for all members of the academic community—including students, faculty, staff, and administrators. It is designed to foster a safe, respectful, inclusive, and professional environment that supports academic excellence, ethical conduct & mutual respect.

A. General Principles

All members of the institution are expected to uphold the following core principles:

1. **Integrity and Honesty**
Conduct oneself with truthfulness, transparency, and accountability in all academic, professional, and personal interactions.
2. **Respect and Dignity**
Treat every individual—regardless of background, role, or identity—with respect, empathy, and fairness.
3. **Equity and Inclusion**
Promote a culture that values diversity, ensures equal opportunity, and actively prevents discrimination or bias.
4. **Professionalism**
Demonstrate responsibility, punctuality, and decorum in all institutional engagements.
5. **Safety and Well-being**
Contribute to a secure, healthy, and supportive environment conducive to learning and growth.
6. **Compliance and Responsibility**
Abide by all institutional policies, codes of conduct, and relevant laws or regulations.
7. **Accountability**
Take ownership of one's actions and use institutional resources with care, responsibility, and integrity.
8. **Commitment to Excellence**
Strive for high standards in teaching, learning, research, and service.

B. Professional Dress Code Policy

❖ Faculty & Staff Dress Code:

Faculty members serve as ambassadors of academic integrity and professionalism. Their appearance significantly influences the institutional atmosphere and sets a standard for student conduct. In alignment with the college's values and commitment to maintaining a respectful academic environment, the following dress code guidelines apply to all teaching and academic staff.

❖ Formal Attire Requirement:

All faculty members are required to wear formal, professional attire while on duty or representing the institution.



❖ **Men's Dress Code:**

Male faculty are expected to wear formal shirts (tucked in), trousers, and formal closed-toe shoes. Casual or sporty clothing is not permitted during official hours.

❖ **Women's Dress Code:**

Female faculty are expected to wear sarees, salwar suits, or other culturally appropriate and professional attire that reflects modesty and formality.

- During Non-academics, Faculty can wear decent and sober Casuals-comfortable, relaxed attire appropriate for the academic environment.

❖ **Activity-Based Exceptions:**

Faculty supervising or participating in physical or co-curricular activities (e.g., sports, yoga, field visits) may be exempted from the formal dress code with prior approval from the Head of Department (HoD). Suitable professional attire relevant to the activity must still be maintained.

❖ **Identification Requirement:**

Faculty must visibly always wear their institutional identity cards while on campus or engaged in any official duty.

❖ **Compliance and Monitoring:**

Responsibility for dress code adherence lies with individual faculty members and their respective Heads of Departments (HoDs), who are to ensure consistent observance and provide guidance as necessary.

C. Code of Conduct for Students

Students are integral members of the academic community and are expected to uphold the values of integrity, respect, responsibility, and discipline in all aspects of their conduct.

- ❖ Students must submit original work in all academic assignments, examinations, and projects.
- ❖ Acts of plagiarism, cheating, or use of unauthorized materials or aids are strictly prohibited.
- ❖ Proper citations and acknowledgment of sources and collaborators are mandatory in all submissions.
- ❖ Academic dishonesty may lead to serious consequences, including failure of assignments, disciplinary action, or disqualification from academic honours.

C1 Behaviour and Discipline

All students are expected to always demonstrate respectful and disciplined behaviour, both within and outside the classroom.



- ❖ Courtesy, respect, and civility must be shown to all faculty, staff, fellow students, and campus visitors.
- ❖ Ragging, bullying, harassment, or discrimination—whether based on caste, religion, gender, language, appearance, or any other identity—is strictly forbidden.
- ❖ Any form of violence, vandalism, theft, or disruption of academic activities is unacceptable.
- ❖ Students are required to comply with institutional rules related to attendance, dress code, classroom behaviour, and event participation.

C2 Digital Conduct

In an academic environment increasingly shaped by digital technologies, students are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, respect, and responsibility when using electronic resources.

Responsible Use of Digital Platforms

Students must use all digital tools and platforms—such as learning management systems, email, forums, messaging apps, video conferencing tools, and social media—ethically, respectfully, and in ways that support a positive and inclusive academic environment.

- ❖ Communication must be courteous, constructive, and aligned with the institution's values of mutual respect and professionalism.
- ❖ Students should avoid the use of language or media that could be interpreted as hostile, inflammatory, or disruptive to the learning community.

Prohibited Digital Conduct

The following behaviours are strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action, which may include suspension of digital privileges, academic penalties, or referral to appropriate administrative bodies:

- ❖ Cyberbullying: Any form of harassment, intimidation, or humiliation conducted through electronic means, including but not limited to insults, threats, spreading rumours, or targeted exclusion.
- ❖ Distribution of Offensive Content: Posting or sharing obscene, sexually explicit, violent, discriminatory, or otherwise offensive material via institutional or personal digital channels.
- ❖ Unauthorized Access: Attempting to gain unauthorized access to institutional systems, networks, accounts, or data, including hacking, phishing, or password theft.
- ❖ Impersonation or Misrepresentation: Using another individual's identity or credentials to gain access or mislead others for any reason.

Data Privacy and Confidentiality



Students are entrusted with access to sensitive information and are expected to treat all digital data with confidentiality and care.

- ❖ Academic Records: All records (grades, assessments, feedback) must be handled in accordance with institutional privacy policies and legal requirements.
- ❖ Personal Information: Students must not share or misuse the personal information of peers, faculty, or staff.
- ❖ Password Security: Students are responsible for safeguarding their own passwords and should not share login credentials under any circumstances.
- ❖ Peer Communication: All private communications between students, such as emails or direct messages, are to be treated respectfully and kept confidential unless consent is given to share them.

Compliance and Accountability

Violations of this digital conduct policy will be taken seriously and addressed through the institution's disciplinary procedures. Depending on the nature and severity of the infraction, consequences may include:

- ❖ Temporary or permanent suspension of access to institutional digital platforms
- ❖ Academic penalties, including failing grades or probation
- ❖ Disciplinary hearings or legal action, particularly in cases involving harassment, data breaches, or unlawful conduct

Support and Education

The institution is committed to fostering a safe and informed digital environment. Students are encouraged to seek guidance and participate in training on digital ethics, cybersecurity, and respectful online communication.

With increasing reliance on digital platforms, students are expected to use all electronic resources ethically and responsibly.

- ❖ Use of institutional or personal digital platforms must reflect respectful and constructive communication.
- ❖ Cyberbullying, sharing of obscene or offensive content, and unauthorized access to institutional systems are strictly prohibited.
- ❖ Confidentiality of academic records, passwords, peer communication, and personal data must be always maintained.

D Code of Conduct for Administrators (Aligned with UGC, AICTE & NEP 2020)

As institutional leaders, administrators are expected to uphold values of ethical governance, academic excellence, and inclusive development. Their conduct must reflect the spirit of the

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National Education Policy 2020, UGC Guidelines, and AICTE Code of Ethics, promoting equity, transparency, and innovation in higher education.

1. Ethical Leadership

- ❖ Lead with integrity, impartiality & professionalism.
- ❖ Make decisions transparently and in the best interests of the institution and its stakeholders.

2. Fairness and Inclusivity

- ❖ Ensure equal opportunity in all institutional processes—admissions, hiring, promotions, and student support.
- ❖ Foster a discrimination-free and harassment-free environment.

3. Accountability and Compliance

- ❖ Adhere to institutional policies and regulatory frameworks (UGC/AICTE/State/National laws).
- ❖ Avoid misuse of authority, institutional data or financial resources.

4. Transparency in Communication

- ❖ Maintain open channels of communication with faculty, staff, students, and external bodies.
- ❖ Disclose policies and decisions clearly and invite stakeholder feedback where appropriate.

5. Academic and Financial Integrity

- ❖ Support academic autonomy, quality assurance, and ethical research practices.
- ❖ Manage institutional funds responsibly, ensuring compliance with audit and procurement norms.

6. Conflict of Interest

- ❖ Declare and appropriately manage any conflicts—personal, financial, or organizational.

7. Commitment to Institutional Vision

- ❖ Promote the goals of access, equity, and excellence as envisioned in the NEP 2020.
- ❖ Encourage innovation, digital transformation, and holistic student development.

E Collegiality and Ethics

A respectful and ethical professional environment is essential to the success and integrity of any academic institution. All members of the academic and administrative community are



expected to uphold collegial values, foster mutual respect, and maintain high ethical standards in their interactions with colleagues.

1. Professional Conduct

- ❖ All individuals must treat colleagues—academic, administrative, and support staff—with fairness, courtesy, and professional respect, regardless of role, seniority, or background.
- ❖ Constructive disagreement and diversity of thought are encouraged, but must be expressed through respectful dialogue and appropriate forums.

2. Integrity in Communication

- ❖ Individuals must refrain from spreading false information, rumours, or making defamatory or derogatory statements about colleagues in any form—verbal, written, or digital.
- ❖ All communication, whether internal or external, should reflect honesty, objectivity, and accountability.

3. Promotion of Collaboration

- ❖ Faculty and staff are expected to contribute to a collegial work environment by promoting teamwork, open dialogue, and knowledge-sharing within and across departments.
- ❖ Active efforts should be made to resolve conflicts through professional dialogue, mediation, or designated institutional channels, rather than through personal or public confrontations.

4. Supportive Work Culture

- ❖ Cultivating a culture of trust, inclusion, and mutual support strengthens departmental cohesion and institutional effectiveness.
- ❖ Encouraging and mentoring colleagues, particularly early-career professionals, is a shared responsibility.

5. Ethical Responsibility

- ❖ Individuals are accountable for maintaining integrity in all professional dealings, including during decision-making, committee work, hiring, and peer review.
- ❖ Ethical concerns or breaches should be reported through appropriate institutional channels, and retaliation against whistleblowers will not be tolerated.

F. Academic and Research Standards



Academic and research excellence form the cornerstone of an institution's reputation and contribution to society. All faculty, researchers, and academic staff are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, intellectual honesty, and scholarly rigor in teaching, research, and publication.

1. Commitment to Academic Excellence

- ❖ Faculty must foster a culture of academic rigor, critical inquiry, and intellectual curiosity in both teaching and research.
- ❖ The development of a scientific temper, evidence-based reasoning, and openness to diverse perspectives should be actively encouraged among students and peers.

2. Originality and Innovation

- ❖ All academic and research work—whether assignments, publications, or projects—must reflect original thought, proper methodology, and independent effort.
- ❖ Collaborative research should clearly define individual contributions and uphold transparency in authorship and funding disclosures.

3. Zero Tolerance for Plagiarism

- ❖ Plagiarism, data falsification, fabrication, or misrepresentation of sources in any academic or research activity is strictly prohibited.
- ❖ Faculty and researchers must adhere to institutional and regulatory (e.g., UGC/AICTE) guidelines on academic integrity and plagiarism detection.
- ❖ Proper citation of sources, including text, data, images, and ideas, is mandatory in all forms of scholarly communication.

4. Responsible Research Conduct

- ❖ All research must be conducted ethically, with respect for intellectual property, human rights, environmental sustainability, and applicable national/international guidelines.
- ❖ Research involving human or animal subjects must obtain proper ethical clearance from relevant review boards.
- ❖ Conflicts of interest, whether financial or professional, must be disclosed and appropriately managed.

5. Mentorship and Academic Ethics

- ❖ Faculty have a duty to mentor students and junior researchers in ethical research practices, scholarly discipline, and academic writing.
- ❖ Misuse of students' or colleagues' research work, ideas, or data without proper acknowledgment is considered academic misconduct.

G. Conflict of Interest



A conflict of interest arises when personal, financial, or other non-institutional interests compromise—or appear to compromise—an individual's professional responsibilities and decision-making. All members of the institution, including faculty, administrators, and staff, must act with transparency, fairness, and integrity, avoiding situations that may undermine institutional trust or impartiality.

A conflict of interest may be:

- ❖ Financial: Personal or family financial interests in contracts, research funding, procurement, or partnerships.
- ❖ Personal/Relational: Relationships that influence or appear to influence employment decisions, grading, supervision, or collaboration.
- ❖ Academic/Professional: Undisclosed dual roles or affiliations that create competing obligations or loyalties.

Maintaining integrity in academic, administrative, and financial matters is a shared responsibility. Even the appearance of impropriety should be avoided to preserve institutional credibility and fairness.

H. Political and Public Engagement

Members of the institution, including faculty, staff and administrators, have the right to participate in political and public affairs as responsible citizens. However, such engagement must be balanced with their professional responsibilities and the institution's commitment to impartiality and inclusiveness.

- ❖ Individuals should ensure that their political activities do not interfere with their official duties or compromise the institution's reputation for neutrality and fairness.
- ❖ Public expressions of political views must be made in a personal capacity and should clearly state that such views do not represent the institution.
- ❖ Use of institutional resources—including time, facilities, digital platforms, and communication channels—for political campaigning or advocacy is strictly prohibited unless explicitly authorized.
- ❖ Engagement in political activities should respect the diversity of opinions within the academic community and avoid creating conflicts or divisions.
- ❖ Staff and faculty must comply with all applicable laws and institutional policies regarding political participation, including restrictions on political endorsements or fundraising on behalf of political entities.
- ❖ Any public statements or participation that could be perceived as official institutional positions must receive prior approval from authorized institutional representatives.

I. Use of Institutional Resources



Institutional resources—including physical facilities, equipment, funds, digital platforms, and intellectual property—are provided to support the academic, administrative, and operational goals of the institution. All members of the institution must use these resources responsibly, ethically & solely for authorized purposes.

- ❖ Institutional resources must not be used for personal gain, political activities, commercial ventures, or any unauthorized purpose.
- ❖ Access to digital platforms, software, and communication tools should be limited to official duties and in compliance with relevant security and privacy policies.
- ❖ Users are responsible for safeguarding institutional property and ensuring its proper use, reporting any misuse, damage, or loss promptly.
- ❖ Unauthorized use, theft, or misappropriation of resources may result in disciplinary action and legal consequences.
- ❖ Staff and faculty should exercise prudence and avoid wasteful or excessive consumption of institutional resources.
- ❖ Intellectual property created using institutional resources or while employment must be managed according to institutional policies on ownership and licensing.

J. Special Provisions

J1. Anti-Ragging

The institution is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and supportive environment for all students. Ragging in any form—whether physical, verbal, psychological, or cyber—is strictly prohibited and will not be tolerated under any circumstances.

- ❖ Ragging includes any act that causes, or is likely to cause, physical or mental harm, embarrassment, harassment, or intimidation to a student.
- ❖ All students, faculty, and staff must remain vigilant and proactive in preventing ragging and must immediately report any incidents or suspicions to designated authorities.
- ❖ The institution shall maintain an Anti-Ragging Committee and a Grievance Redressal Cell to investigate complaints promptly and take appropriate disciplinary action.
- ❖ Disciplinary measures for confirmed ragging offenses may include warnings, suspension, expulsion, or referral to law enforcement as per relevant laws and institutional regulations.
- ❖ Awareness programs, counselling, and support services shall be regularly conducted to foster a culture of respect, empathy, and zero tolerance towards ragging.
- ❖ Students are encouraged to uphold the dignity of their peers and actively participate in creating a safe campus environment.



J2. Harassment and Discrimination

The institution is committed to fostering a safe, inclusive, and respectful environment free from any form of harassment or discrimination. Such behaviour undermines the dignity and rights of individuals and is strictly prohibited.

- ❖ Harassment includes unwelcome conduct—verbal, physical, visual, or digital—that creates a hostile, intimidating, or offensive environment. This includes sexual harassment, bullying, stalking, and any form of abuse.
- ❖ Discrimination refers to unfair or prejudicial treatment based on race, gender, age, religion, ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic.
- ❖ All members of the institution—students, faculty, and staff—are expected to treat each other with respect and dignity, upholding principles of equity and inclusion.
- ❖ The institution shall maintain clear procedures for reporting and investigating complaints related to harassment or discrimination, ensuring confidentiality, impartiality, and timely resolution.
- ❖ Support services, including counselling and advocacy, shall be available to victims of harassment or discrimination.
- ❖ Perpetrators of harassment or discrimination will be subject to disciplinary action, which may include warnings, suspension, termination, or legal referral, depending on the severity of the offense.
- ❖ Retaliation against individuals who report incidents in good faith is strictly prohibited and will be dealt with severely.

The institution maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy toward sexual harassment and discrimination, ensuring a safe and inclusive environment for all. Complaints are handled promptly, fairly, and confidentially by the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), which is responsible for investigating cases and recommending appropriate disciplinary actions in accordance with institutional policies and legal frameworks. To promote respect and equality, regular Gender Sensitization and Awareness Programs are conducted for students, faculty, and staff. Furthermore, retaliation against anyone who reports harassment or discrimination in good faith is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary measures.

J3. Substance Abuse

- ❖ Use, possession, distribution, or promotion of illegal drugs, alcohol, or controlled substances on campus or during institution-related activities is strictly prohibited.
- ❖ Substance abuse jeopardizes the health, safety, and well-being of the community and disrupts the academic environment.
- ❖ Violations may result in disciplinary actions such as counselling, suspension, expulsion, and referral to law enforcement.



- ❖ The institution will provide awareness programs and support services aimed at prevention and rehabilitation.

J4. Attendance, Punctuality & Leave Policy Adherence

Commitment to Presence: Faculty, staff & administration are expected to attend all scheduled working hours, meetings, and official events punctually to ensure smooth functioning of the institute.

- ❖ **Punctuality:** Arriving on time and being prepared for duties is essential. Timeliness demonstrates professionalism and respect for colleagues, students, and institutional operations.
- ❖ **Reporting Absences:** In cases of illness, emergencies, or unavoidable circumstances, employees must notify their immediate designated authority as early as possible, following established procedures.
- ❖ **Substitute Arrangements:** Faculty should make appropriate arrangements for classes or duties in their absence, ensuring minimal disruption to students' learning.
- ❖ **Accountability:** Repeated tardiness or unauthorized absences may impact performance evaluations and can lead to formal disciplinary action according to institute policies.
- ❖ **Work Ethic:** Consistent attendance and punctuality reflect commitment to institutional goals and contribute to a positive workplace culture.

Timekeeping and Records

- ❖ Employees must accurately log their working hours using the institution's official system (biometric).
- ❖ Tampering with attendance records is a serious offense and will result in disciplinary action.

Leave Policy Adherence

- ❖ All staff are expected to follow institutional policies when requesting and availing of leave (sick leave, casual leave, vacation, etc.).
- ❖ Unauthorized leave may be considered absenteeism and could affect salary or employment status.

Professional Availability

- ❖ Faculty and staff must be available during designated working hours for meetings, student support, and institutional duties.
- ❖ Frequent unavailability during work hours, even if present on campus, may be considered dereliction of duty.

Leadership by Example

- ❖ Faculty and administrative leaders should model punctuality and reliability, setting a positive example for students and junior staff.
- ❖ Senior staff are expected to encourage and enforce a culture of time discipline across departments.

J5. Grievance Redressal Mechanism

The institution provides a clear and transparent process for students, faculty, and staff to formally raise grievances related to academic, administrative, or behavioural issues. Complaints should be submitted in writing and will be handled promptly, fairly, and confidentially. All parties involved will have the opportunity to present their perspectives, and efforts will be made to resolve issues within a reasonable timeframe. If needed, matters may be escalated to appropriate authorities or external experts. Decisions will be communicated in writing, and those dissatisfied have the right to appeal. Retaliation against individuals reporting grievances in good faith is strictly prohibited. Awareness programs will be conducted to promote understanding of the grievance process.

J6. Implementation and Compliance

The institution is committed to the effective implementation and strict compliance of all policies outlined in this document. Responsibility for enforcement lies with designated authorities across academic and administrative units. Regular monitoring, audits, and reviews will be conducted to ensure adherence to the code of conduct and related regulations. All members of the institution are expected to familiarize themselves with these policies and cooperate fully with compliance measures. Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action according to the severity of the violation.

J7. Amendments and Review

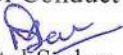
This policy document is subject to periodic review to ensure its relevance, effectiveness, and alignment with evolving legal, regulatory, and institutional requirements. Amendments may be proposed by authorized bodies or stakeholders and will be reviewed and approved through established governance procedures. All changes will be communicated promptly to the institutional community. Stakeholders are encouraged to provide feedback to help improve the policy. The review process will occur at regular intervals or as necessitated by significant developments.



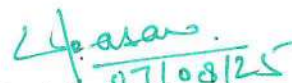
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